

A6 will still be Samsung made

Samsung will still be producing the quad-core processors to be used in Apple's next iPhone, despite the bitter court battle between the two companies.

Salted disk

Impregnating a hard disk platter with salt has been proven to increase its capacity by six times – <http://tgr.ph/nS5SRJ>

TABLET



Mercury MTab

Price: ₹9,499

PROJECTOR



LG AF115 projector

Price: ₹1,60,000

KEYBOARD



Microsoft Wireless Desktop 2000

Price: ₹1,650

CAMERA



Nikon COOLPIX S9100

Price: ₹18,950

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor.....1GHz
RAM.....512 MB
Storage.....4GB with memory card slot
Platform.....Android 2.3
Ports.....Mini HDMI

Projector.....SXRD projection system
Native resolution.....1920x1080 (1080p)
Brightness.....1500 lumens
Contrast ratio.....30000:1
Ports.....2 HDMI inputs

Connection2.4 GHz wireless, BlueTrack technology
Security.....Advanced Encryption Standard (AES) 128-bit encryption
Special features... Easy access hot keys

Display3-inch TFT LCD
Resolution.....12.1 MP
Optical zoom.....18X
Self timer2 sec and 10 sec
ISO range ... 160, 400, 800, 1600, 3200

TEST CENTRE RATINGS (All scores out of 10)

Features.....6.0

At least on paper, the MTab has a good specification set. It comes with a 7-inch screen and a mini HDMI port.

Performance5.5

Overall performance is average, but it has ordinary overall display quality. Sound output leaves a lot to be desired as well.

Build Quality.....5.0

It's like a previous generation tablet – bulky.

Value for Money6.0

The Mtab is priced attractively and is one of the most inexpensive Android tablets in the market.

Features.....8.0

Very loaded in terms of features – 2 HDMI inputs, 1500 lumens and 30000:1 contrast ratio.

Performance8.0

Delightful. Handles HD and SD content brilliantly. No audio handling capabilities though.

Build Quality.....7.0

Looks good with solid build but the glossy finish is a dust and fingerprint magnet.

Value for Money5.5

The LG AF115 does cost quite a bit, but high-performance full HD projectors aren't exactly affordable, at least not the good ones.

Features.....6.0

Media centre compatible with hot keys to access frequent apps.

Performance6.0

Pillow texture palmrest with well spaced out keys. Response time is quite good.

Build Quality.....6.5

Sturdy build with a matte black hard plastic back panel, glossy finish on the upper top half and a slip-resistant palm rest.

Value for money.....7.0

Decent build quality together with Microsoft's exclusive BlueTrack sensor technology makes this combo a great buy for the price.

Features.....6.0

S9100 offers 25mm wide angle to 450mm telephoto combined with a 12MP CMOS sensor.

Performance6.0

It shoots sharp images. With its optical quality sensor, pics appear good, all the way from 25-140mm.

Build Quality.....6.5

It has a Nikon ED glass lens with rotatory slider controls on the top and integrated pop-up flash.

Value for money.....5.5

At ₹18,950, it offers 18x optical wide-angle zoom which produces sharp images. But it's a touch costly compared to other cameras.

WE SAY

5.5

The MTab seems to have excellent specs on paper, but the end product is let down by the bulky form factor and the 7-inch display that leaves a lot to be desired.

It looks a lot like the original Samsung Galaxy Tab P1000, with minor tweaks in the button placement and the mini HDMI port. In the current day and age, we call that bulky! We would seriously recommend spending that extra bit of money on the Reliance 3G Tab. The 3G Tab is a far superior product overall, but it's network locked to the Reliance network. The MTab may be one of the cheapest Android tablets out there, but not recommendable.

8.0

LG touts the AF115 as a premium home cinema projector, and post evaluation, we have to agree. At ₹1.6 lakh, the AF115 costs quite a bit, but high-performance full HD projectors aren't exactly affordable. However, it only works in a set-up that involves dedicated home theatre hardware. If you're looking at building a serious cinema system in your home, the AF115 is definitely worth considering. As an alternate, you have the Panasonic PT-AE4000E. It costs ₹30k less than the LG AF115 and offers a very similar spec sheet and performance. The AF115 will please videophile movie-buffs with deep pockets.

7.0

Microsoft Wireless Desktop 2000 is definitely impressive to users interested in wireless keyboard and mouse combos with interactive user keys, comfortable palm grip and extended battery life. All of these features along with attractive price become selling points for the Wireless Desktop. It's ideal for most users today who'd rather not be constrained to their desks by wires.

Some of the major points in favour of buying this keyboard mouse combo is the encrypted connections and a host of customisable buttons. Well worth the purchase, we think.

6.0

At ₹18,950, the S9100 is a better package compared to its predecessor the S8000, courtesy a new sensor and much more versatile zoom lens.

Image quality is very good in daylight conditions and HD video footage looks great. It's also one of the fastest and most responsive cameras in its class.

The only major negative points are sub-par image quality in poor light at high ISO settings and very little manual exposure control.

A built-in GPS would've been a great addition to the camera's feature list, but if you don't require every feature under the moon, check this out.